Introduction

This document outlines the modeling guidelines for **Interface Fact Sheets** within the enterprise architecture framework at Porsche. It builds upon the **PAG General Modeling Guidelines** and provides specific instructions for creating and maintaining Interface Fact Sheets in **LeanIX**. The creation process follows the general fact sheet creation procedure described in *"How to Create a Fact Sheet."*

Description

In LeanIX, interfaces are modeled from a **business-oriented perspective**. They represent the **data exchange and integration** between **IT Products**. Each Interface Fact Sheet captures:

- The **direction of data flow**
- The **type of data transfer**
- The **frequency of exchange**
- The **underlying IT Products** (software, hardware, or services)

This approach enables a clear understanding of how systems interact and supports strategic decision-making across business and IT.

General Modeling Rules

Lifecycle Management in LeanIX Fact Sheets

Each **Fact Sheet type** in LeanIX can be assigned a **lifecycle**. Whether this assignment is **mandatory** depends on the specific Fact Sheet type and is indicated on its detail page.

Recommended Practice

Regardless of whether the lifecycle is mandatory, it is **strongly recommended** to provide the following information:

- **Start of productive use** (Go-Live date)
- **Decommissioning date** (if known)

Depending on the desired level of detail, additional lifecycle milestones can also be modeled (e.g., development start, pilot phase, sunset planning).

Benefits

Accurate lifecycle data supports:

- **Strategic planning** and **portfolio management**
- **Compliance** with regulatory and audit requirements
- **Impact analysis** for changes and decommissioning
- **Architecture governance** across all layers

Modeling Organizations in an Interface

No organizational assignments are modeled on an interface fact sheet. All responsibilities and uses of the interface are derived from the assigned provider IT product!

Specific Modelling Rules and Best Practices for an Interface

Interface Creation

Interfaces must be created by the IT product provider!

However, if an interface was not modeled when the product owner created the IT product, **any user consuming the interface** can and should create it and associate it with the IT product providing it. All modeling must comply with the defined guidelines.

Naming Conventions

While there is no strict naming rule, it is recommended to include:

- The **source IT Product**
- The **technology used** (e.g., REST, GraphQL)
- Optionally, the **target system** (if it's a point-to-point connection)

Examples:

- `LeanIX EAM GraphQL`
- `LeanIX EAM Collibra`

This improves discoverability and transparency for business architecture modeling.

Responsibility Assignment

Each interface must be linked to a **responsible person**. By default, this is the person responsible for the associated IT Product. If no responsible person is assigned, an automated process will assign the responsible person from the related IT Product.

Interfaces Without IT Product Association

Interfaces not linked to an IT Product are marked with the tag `"to delete"`. During quality assurance, responsible users are contacted. If no response is received, the interface will be **archived after 30 days**.

Interface Versioning

A new version should only be created if:

- The **interface type** changes
- The **content or structure** of the interface changes

Example: One IT Product uses version 1, another uses version 2. The decision to version remains with the responsible person.

Interfaces to External Systems

In enterprise architecture, it is common for IT Products to **interact with external systems**—for example, to exchange data with banks, government agencies, or third-party services. These systems are considered **external** if they:

- Are **not part of the Porsche network** (including ToGe networks),
- Are **not operated by PAG**, a **subsidiary**, or a **group brand**,
- Are **not part of the internal Porsche IT landscape**.

  ⚠ **Important:** External systems **must not be modeled as IT Products** in LeanIX.

Instead, interactions with external systems are documented **exclusively** through Interface Fact Sheets.

Modeling Guidelines:

- Create an **Interface Fact Sheet** to represent the connection.
- Name the interface clearly to indicate it connects to an external system.
- Assign the **consuming IT Product** as the **consumer** of the interface.
- Assign a **responsible person** on the consuming side.

Examples:

1. **Customs Integration:**
   - **Scenario:** The IT Product `Zollabfertigung` (Customs Clearance) consumes a REST API provided by the German Customs Authority.
   - **Interface Name:** `External: Zollbehörde REST`
   - **Consumer:** `Zollabfertigung`
   - **Responsible Person:** Defined on the `Zollabfertigung` Fact Sheet
2. **Credit Check Integration:**
   - **Scenario:** The IT Product `Kreditprüfung` (Credit Check) uses a SOAP interface from SCHUFA.
   - **Interface Name:** `External: SCHUFA SOAP`
   - **Consumer:** `Kreditprüfung`
   - **Responsible Person:** Defined on the `Kreditprüfung` Fact Sheet

This modeling approach ensures that external dependencies are **clearly visible**, **traceable**, and **governed** without violating LeanIX modeling principles.

Technical Implementation of Interfaces

Interfaces are not always implemented directly by the IT Product that provides or consumes them. In many cases, **middleware platforms**, **API gateways**, or **integration services** handle the technical implementation.

This separation between **logical ownership** and **technical realization** is essential for accurate modeling and architecture governance.

Modeling Guidelines:

- The **logical interface** is modeled between the **provider** and **consumer** IT Products.
- The **technical implementation** is modeled by linking a **platform IT Product** (e.g., middleware, API gateway) in the "Technical Architecture" section of the Interface Fact Sheet.
- This allows for **clear separation of concerns**: business logic vs. technical infrastructure.

Examples:

1. **API Gateway Integration:**
   - **Scenario:** `LeanIX` provides an API, but the actual technical delivery is handled via the `Porsche API Gateway`.
   - **Interface Name:** `LeanIX EAM GraphQL`
   - **Provider:** `LeanIX`
   - **Consumer:** Any consuming IT Product
   - **Technical Implementation:** `API Management Service` (linked in the Interface Fact Sheet)
2. **Middleware-Based Integration:**
   - **Scenario:** `CRM System` and `ERP System` exchange data via a middleware called `Integration Hub`.
   - **Interface Name:** `CRM to ERP Sync`
   - **Provider:** `CRM System`
   - **Consumer:** `ERP System`

- **Technical Implementation:** `Integration Hub` (middleware platform)

Structure Summary – Interface Fact Sheets in LeanIX

Section	Key Concept	Description / Rule	Example(s)
Introduction	Interface Fact Sheet	Object in LeanIX to model data exchange between IT Products	—
Conceptual Overview	Business-oriented modeling	Focus on data flow, transfer type, frequency, and IT components	—
Interface Creation	Consumer modeling allowed	Consumers may create interfaces if not modeled by providers	User creates interface for consumed API
Naming Convention	Source + Technology + Target (optional)	Improves discoverability and transparency	`LeanIX EAM GraphQL`, `LeanIX EAM Collibra`
Responsibility Assignment	Responsible = IT Product owner	Auto-assigned if missing	Subscription inherited from IT Product
Orphan Interfaces	Tag = "to delete"	Archived after 30 days if unresolved	Interface without IT Product link
Versioning	New version = type/content change	Optional, based on usage	v1 used by Product A, v2 by Product B
External Systems	External systems not modeled as IT Products	Use Interface Fact Sheet only	`External: Zollbehörde REST`, `External: SCHUFA SOAP`
External System Definition	Outside Porsche network	Not operated by PAG, subsidiaries, or group brands	Banks, SCHUFA, Customs, Tax Authorities
External Interface Modeling	Consumer-side responsibility	Interface created and owned by consuming IT Product	`Zollabfertigung` consumes Customs API
Technical Implementation	Middleware or platform IT Product	Technical delivery handled by separate IT Product	`Porsche Developer Hub` implements `LeanIX EAM GraphQL`
Technical vs Logical Layer	Separation of concerns	Logical interface between systems, technical via platform	`CRM to ERP Sync` via `Integration Hub`
Feature Status	Technical architecture section (WIP)	Not yet available in LeanIX as of July 2025	—
Organizational Modeling	No direct org assignment on interface	Responsibilities are derived from the assigned provider IT Product	Interface inherits responsibility from `LeanIX` as provider

Metamodel View

The diagram shows the possible relations between the entities that can be used to model an Interface in the context of the appropriate architecture level.

LLM-Ready Description

✅ LLM-Ready Description: Metamodel View – Interface

Overview

The diagram titled **"Metamodel View Interface"** illustrates the conceptual relationships between **Initiatives**, **IT Products/Platforms**, and **Interfaces** within the context of enterprise architecture modeling in **LeanIX**. It aligns with the **TOGAF® framework**, specifically the **Architecture Vision** and **Business Architecture** phases.

Diagram Structure

The diagram is divided into **two horizontal sections**, each representing a different architectural perspective:

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1. Upper Section – Strategic Alignment (TOGAF® A: Architecture Vision)

- **Element:** `Initiative` (colored pink)
- **Element:** `Interface` (colored green)
- **Relationship:** A **downward arrow** from `Initiative` to `Interface` indicates that the **initiative is influenced by or dependent on the interface**.
- **Contextual Tag:** A yellow circle labeled **"TOGAF® A. Architecture Vision"** is placed to the right, signifying that this relationship supports **strategic planning and vision alignment**.

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2. Lower Section – Operational Dependency (TOGAF® B: Business Architecture)

- **Element:** `IT Product / Platform` (colored pink)
- **Element:** `Interface` (colored green)
- **Relationship:** A **rightward arrow** from `IT Product / Platform` to `Interface` indicates that the **IT Product or Platform requires the interface to function**.
- **Contextual Tag:** A yellow circle labeled **"TOGAF® B. Business Architecture"** is placed to the right, signifying that this relationship supports **business capability modeling and operational design**.

Key Modeling Concepts

Element	Type	Color	Role in Model
Initiative	Business Object	Pink	Represents a strategic project or transformation initiative
IT Product / Platform	Application	Pink	Represents a system or platform that delivers business or technical capabilities
Interface	Integration	Green	Represents a data or service exchange point between IT Products
TOGAF® A	Framework Tag	Yellow	Indicates strategic alignment (Architecture Vision)
TOGAF® B	Framework Tag	Yellow	Indicates business architecture alignment

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Modeling Implications in LeanIX

- **Interfaces** are central integration points that connect **strategic initiatives** and **operational systems**.
- **Initiatives** may depend on the availability or design of specific interfaces to achieve business goals.
- **IT Products** consume or provide interfaces, which must be modeled to reflect **technical dependencies**.
- The diagram supports **cross-layer traceability** from **strategy to execution** in LeanIX.